Yousef Khudher

// CYBERSECURITY EXPERT · PURPLE TEAM SPECIALIST · CO-FOUNDER

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Iraq · Open to Remote / Relocation

570+ Bug Bounty Disclosures | 100+ Contract Engagement Findings | 36 Industry Certifications
14 OffSec Certs (All) | #1 Iraq — HTB Cyber Apocalypse 2025 | 341+ Red & Blue Team Reports
60%→15% SOC False Positives | 2d→3h Recon Time via Custom Scanners

CORE SKILLS

- Purple Team Operations
- Adversary Emulation
- Penetration Testing
- Vulnerability Research
- Threat Hunting (OSTH)
- Incident Response (OSIR)
- MITRE ATT&CK
- SIEM / ELK Stack
- Web / Mobile AppSec
- Active Directory Attacks
- Wireless Attacks
- Cloud Security (AWS/Azure)
- ISO 27001 Lead Auditor
- ISO 27701 Lead Auditor
- Security Team Leadership

TOOLS

- Burp Suite
- Metasploit
- Nmap / Nessus
- Wireshark
- ELK / Splunk
- Cobalt Strike

PROGRAMMING

- Python
- Bash / PowerShell
- C / C++

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Purple Team specialist and co-founder with deep hands-on expertise spanning both offensive and defensive operations. I bridge Red Team adversary simulation with Blue Team detection engineering — validating security controls end-to-end using the **MITRE ATT&CK** framework, SIEM/ELK, and custom tooling.

Holder of **all 14 OffSec certifications** — a combination held by very few professionals globally — alongside 36 total industry certifications including **ISO/IEC 27001 & 27701 Lead Auditor**. Ranked **1st in Iraq and 19th globally** at HTB Cyber Apocalypse 2025 out of 18,000+ players. Discovered and responsibly disclosed **570+ vulnerabilities** across HackerOne and global bug bounty platforms, plus **100+** under contracted engagements with Iraqi companies.

A decade of hands-on technical work since 2016 — from freelance development and ISP network administration to national-scale security operations. Based in Iraq, open to on-site or remote engagements in security operations, red/purple team leadership, and AppSec roles globally.

EXPERIENCE

PRIVATE COMPANY — CONFIDENTIAL
2025 – Present · Full-time

Security Operations Leader (Red Team) – Co-Founder

May 2026 – Present · 6 mos

Co-founded the venture and leads a **team of 4–5 security engineers** — directing red team strategy and full-scope adversary emulation across initial access, privilege escalation, lateral movement, and post-exploitation. Builds offensive tooling and attack infrastructure including C2 frameworks, redirectors, and custom payloads. Identified and responsibly disclosed **100+ vulnerabilities** under **contracted security engagements** with Iraqi companies — assessing production

- C# / .NET
- Dart / Flutter
- Java / JavaScript

CERTIFICATIONS

OffSec — All 14

OSCE³ · OSCP+ · OSEP · OSWE · OSED · OSWP · OSWA · OSDA · OSTH · OSIR · KLCP · OSCC-SJD · OSCC-SEC

CyberWarfare Labs

CRTA · MCRTA · MCBTA · DO-RTA

Governance

ISO 27001 · ISO 27701

Network

CCNA · CCNP · MTCNA

EDUCATION

B.Eng. Computer Engineering

University of Mosul

Final project: IDS using ML — detected ARP spoofing, TCP/TFTP anomalies on live traffic.

LANGUAGES

Arabic — Native

English — Professional

applications including **Mantaqty** (Codion Solutions), **Linkchi for Software Solutions**, **FOR YOU MARKET**, and **Shaghlaty**.

Red Team · Co-Founder · Adversary Emulation · C2 / Attack Infra · Vulnerability Disclosure

AppSec Specialist / Penetration Tester / Testing Team Lead

2025 – Present · Full-time

Leads application security testing engagements — assessing web and mobile applications, coordinating test coverage across the team, and reporting critical findings to stakeholders. Built custom scanning tooling that cut reconnaissance from **two days to roughly three hours** per assessment, letting the team cover more targets per engagement.

Application Security · Penetration Testing · Team Leadership · Web / Mobile AppSec

MINISTRY OF INTERIOR — IRAQ

Cybersecurity Specialist – Purple Team · SOC Engineer

Dec 2024 – Present · Full-time

Secures a national-scale environment spanning **1,000+ local and public-facing systems**, **100+ servers**, thousands of endpoints, and **millions of end users**. Reduced SOC false positives from **60% to 15%** through systematic detection tuning, sharply cutting analyst alert fatigue. Delivered **341+ red team and blue team assessment reports** to date. Operates as SOC engineer and cross-layer security advisor across network, endpoint, application, and infrastructure defense, validating detection coverage against MITRE ATT&CK using ELK SIEM.

Red Team · Blue Team · SOC Engineering · MITRE ATT&CK · SIEM / ELK · Threat Intel

MINISTRY OF INTERIOR & MINISTRY OF COMMUNICATIONS — IRAQ

Cybersecurity Competition Judge / Supervisor

2024 – 2025 · Part-time

Supervised and judged 3 national-level cybersecurity competitions on behalf of Iraqi government ministries — two for the Ministry of Interior (2024–2025) and one for the Ministry of Communications (2025).

CTF Design · Competition Judging · Mentorship

MOI CYBERSECURITY DIRECTORATE — IRAQ

CTF Supervisor, National Internship Program

2024 – 2025

Supervised a nationwide internship CTF for the Ministry of Interior Cybersecurity Directorate, with approximately **500 participating students** from across Iraq.

MINISTRY OF INTERIOR — IRAQ · SAME EMPLOYER

Red Team Penetration Tester

2025 – Apr 2026 · 8 mos

Conducted red team engagements and offensive penetration tests against enterprise infrastructure and applications, emulating real-world adversary tradecraft. Findings fed directly into purple team detection-tuning work.

Red Team · Adversary Emulation · Infrastructure Pentesting

AMC — IRAQ

Penetration Tester

May 2024 – Jan 2025 · 9 mos

Conducted internal and external penetration tests. Developed custom security tooling in Python and C++ to automate vulnerability discovery.

`Web App Pentesting` `Network Pentesting` `Python / C++`

AMC — IRAQ

SOC Engineer

Nov 2023 – Apr 2024 · Full-time

Monitored security events, triaged alerts, and performed incident response with SIEM tooling. Developed detection playbooks to standardize analyst response.

`SOC` `Incident Response` `SIEM`

SELF-EMPLOYED — IRAQ & MENA

Independent Security Consultant & Application Developer

2018 – Present

Advise companies across Iraq and the MENA region on security posture, control gaps, and governance (ISO 27001 / 27701, PCI-DSS, NIST), delivering assessments and penetration tests with formal reports. Design and build websites and custom software for regional clients with security hardening built in, plus bespoke automation tooling that absorbs repetitive assessment work without adding headcount.

`Security Consulting` `GRC Advisory` `Web Development` `Automation`

ALMADAR ISP / FREELANCE — IRAQ

Network Administrator & Network Engineer

2022 – 2023

Administered live ISP production network infrastructure — routing, switching, DNS/ARP/TCP-IP, and firewall configuration — alongside call-center IT support.

`Networking` `ISP Infrastructure` `Firewalls`

INDEPENDENT — HACKERONE & REGIONAL PLATFORMS

Bug Bounty Security Researcher

2022 – Present

Discovered and responsibly disclosed 570+ vulnerabilities (Critical → Medium) across global bug bounty programs. Delivered detailed PoC reports and remediation guidance. Targeted web applications, APIs, and network infrastructure.

`HackerOne` `Web App` `API Security` `Bug Bounty`

NORTH TECHNICAL UNIVERSITY & UNIVERSITY OF MOSUL — IRAQ

Academic Security Project Supervisor & Mentor

2016 – Present · Part-time

Designed and supervised **100+ Bachelor's, Master's, and PhD projects** in network security and cybersecurity — IDS/IPS, secure communications, and Arduino/Raspberry Pi hardware security with custom PCB design — all achieving Excellent grades. Mentor juniors across UX/UI, databases, and system optimization.

`Mentorship` `Arduino / RPi` `Research`

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

IT Specialist → Senior Data Entry Clerk · Freelance Developer

2016 – 2023

AMC (2021–2023): processed 5,000+ records daily into CRM/ERP at 99% accuracy; standardized templates improved team productivity 20% and cut data errors 10%; mentored 4 clerks and was promoted. **Self-employed (2016–2021):** built production mobile applications in **Flutter** for local companies; ran a website-development-as-a-service business delivering **WordPress** sites and custom retail software; bug bounty testing with custom pentest tooling; Minecraft mods in Java.

`Flutter / Dart` `WordPress` `Java` `Process Improvement`

VULNERABILITY RESEARCH

570+

VULNERABILITIES DISCLOSED

Reported across **HackerOne** and global bug bounty platforms, severity range Critical to Medium. Separately, **100+ vulnerabilities** identified under **contracted security engagements** with Iraqi companies — assessing production applications including **Mantaqty** (Codion Solutions), **Linkchi for Software Solutions**, **FOR YOU MARKET**, and **Shaghlaty**.

CTF & COMPETITION ACHIEVEMENTS

#1 Iraq · #19 Global
HTB Cyber Apocalypse 2025
18,000+ players worldwide · Solo

#52 / 796 teams
Global Cyber Skills Benchmark 2025
77/103 challenges · 36,675 pts (HTB)

#51 / 663
RITSEC CTF
Solo squad · Global

Also placed: **#55 / 3,175** EC-Council Hackerverse · **Top 61 / 1,668** DownUnderCTF 6 · **Top Rank** VishwaCTF'26 (CyberCell VIT + Bugcrowd)